Management Information Systems

ICT2242

Collaboration and Social Business

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Lecture 03

What we discuss Today ……..

- What is Collaboration
- Why Collaboration and Teamwork are Important
- What is Social Business
- Applications of Social Business
- Business Benefits of Collaboration and Social Business
- Traditional Business vs Collaborative Business
- Tools and Technologies for Collaboration and Social Business
- How to find the correct collaboration software for your firm
- The Role of the Information Systems Function in a business

Summary of Global E-Business

- Business Processes and Information Systems
- Types of Information Systems
  - Systems for Different Management Groups
    - Transaction processing systems
    - Systems for Business intelligence
  - Systems for Linking the Enterprise
    - Enterprise applications
    - Intranets and Extranets
  - E-business, E-commerce and E-government

What is Collaboration ?

- **Collaboration** is working with others to achieve shared and explicit goals.
- Collaboration focuses on
  - Task or mission accomplishment
  - Usually takes place in
    - a business,
    - or other organization,
    - and between businesses.

What is Collaboration ?

- Collaboration can be
  - short-lived, lasting a few minutes
  - or longer term
- Collaboration can be
  - one-to-one
  - or many-to-many
- Employees may collaborate in
  - Informal groups
  - Formal teams

Why Collaboration and Teamwork are Important ?

- Changing nature of work
- Growth of professional work
- Changing organization of the firm
- Changing scope of the firm
- Emphasis on innovation
- Changing culture of work and business

What is Social Business ?

- The use of social networking platforms, including Facebook, twitter and internal corporate social tools to engage their employees, customers, and suppliers.
- The goal of social business is
  - to deepen interactions with groups inside and outside the firm
  - to expedite and enhance
    - Information Sharing
    - Innovation
    - and Decision Making

What is Social Business ?

- A key word in social business is “Conversations”.
- If firms could tune into conversations , they would strengthen their bonds with consumers, suppliers and employees, increasing their emotional involvement in the firm.
- Social Business requires a great deal of transparency.

Applications of Social Business

- Social Networks
  - Connect through personal and business profiles
- Crowdsourcing
  - Harness collective knowledge to generate new ideas and solutions
- Shared Workspaces
  - Coordinate projects and tasks
  - Co-create content
- Blogs and Wikis
  - Publish and rapidly access knowledge
  - Discuss opinions and experiences

Applications of Social Business

- Social Commerce
  - Share opinions about purchasing or purchase on social platforms
- File Sharing
  - Upload, share and comment on photos, videos, audios text documents
- Social Marketing
  - Use Social media to interact with customers
  - Derive customer insights
- Communities
  - Discuss topics in open forums
  - Share expertise

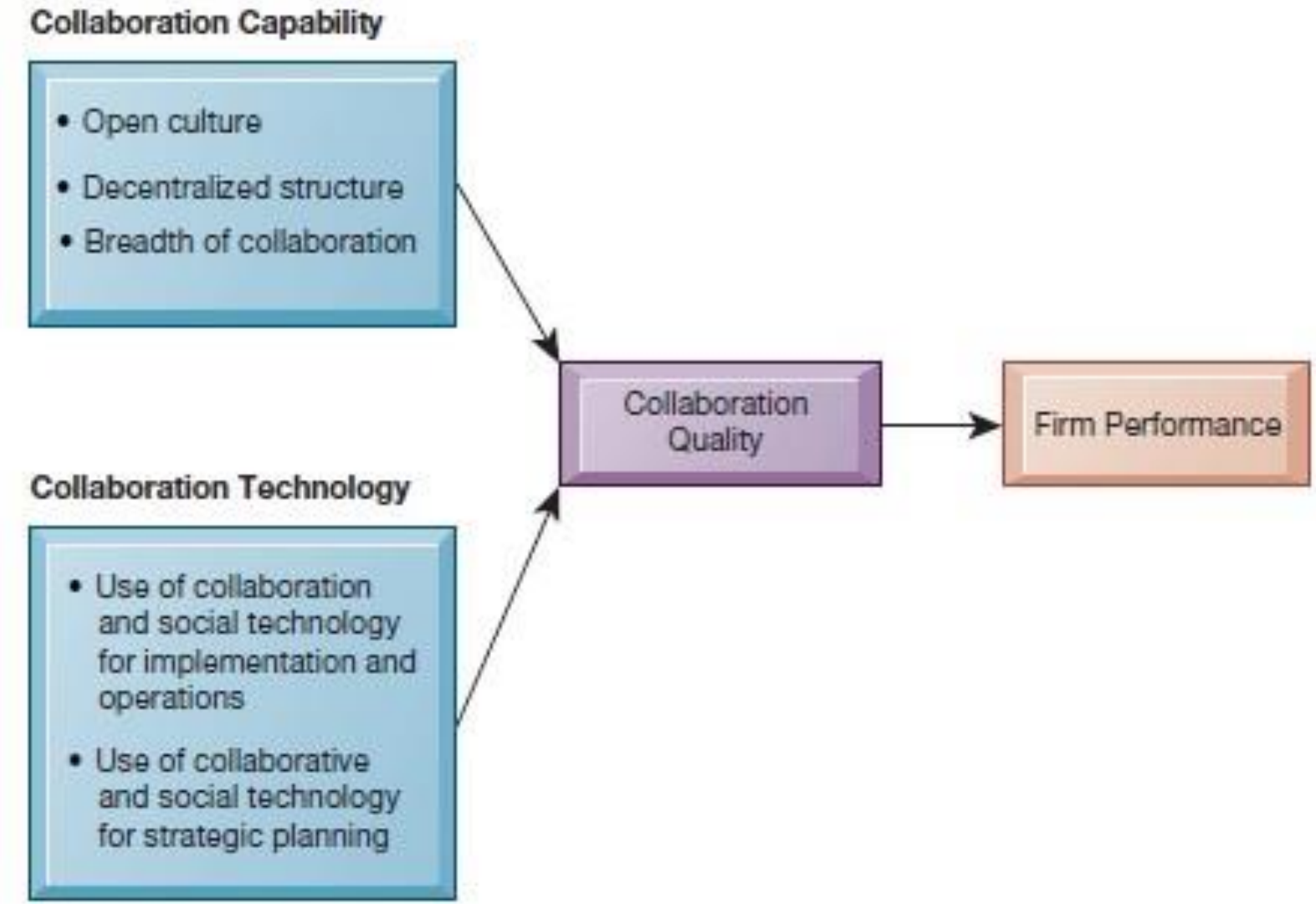
Business Benefits of Collaboration and Social Business

- Productivity
  - Capture expert knowledge and solve problems more rapidly
  - Fewer errors
- Quality
  - Can communicate errors and corrective actions faster
  - Reduce time delays in design and production
- Innovation
  - Innovative ideas for products, services and administration
  - Advantages to diversity and "Wisdom of crowds"

Business Benefits of Collaboration and Social Business

- Customer service
  - solve customer complaints and issues faster and more effectively
- Financial performance (profitability, sales, and sales growth)
  - As a result of all of the above, collaborative firms have superior sales growth and financial performance

Requirements for Collaboration



Traditional Business vs Collaborative Business

- Traditional
  - Command and control firms
  - Required lower-level employees to carry out orders without asking too many questions
  - No responsibility to improve processes
  - No rewards for teamwork or team performance
  - Never communicated horizontally, always vertically
  - As long as employees showed up for work, and performed the job satisfactorily, that's all that was required

Traditional Business vs Collaborative Business

- Collaborative
  - Senior managers are responsible for achieving results
  - Rely on teams of employees to achieve and implement the results
  - Teams are rewarded for their performance, and individuals are rewarded for their performance in a team
  - The function of middle managers is to build the teams, coordinate their work, and monitor their performance

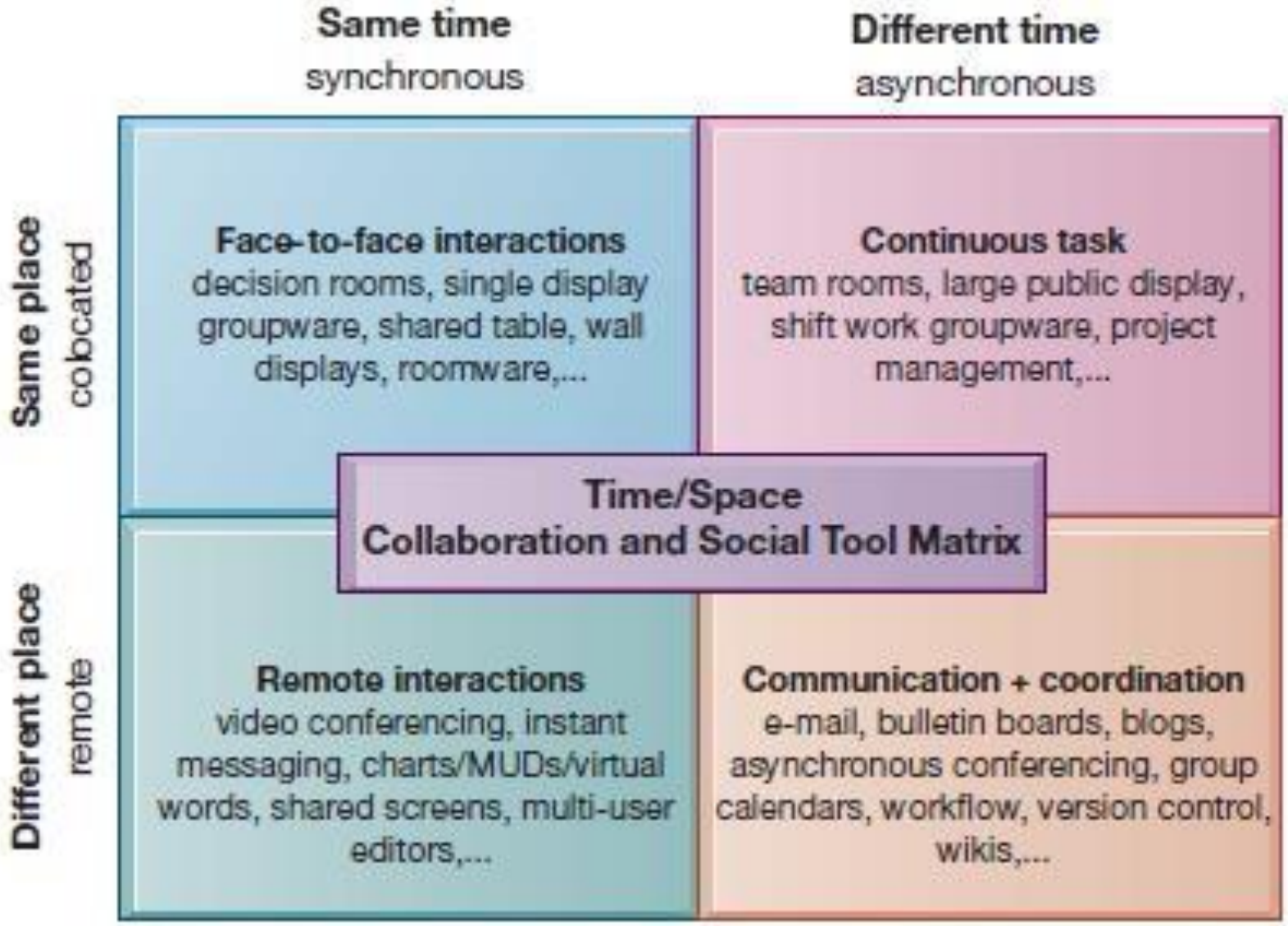
Tools and Technologies for Collaboration and Social Business

- E-mail and Instant Messaging (IM)
- Social Networking
- Wikis
- Virtual Worlds
- Collaboration and Social Business Platforms
  - Virtual meeting systems
    - Telepresence
  - Cloud collaboration services
    - Google tools and Cyber lockers
  - Microsoft SharePoint
  - IBM Notes
  - Enterprise social networking tools

Enterprise Social Networking Software Capabilities

- Profiles
- Content sharing
- Feeds and notifications
- Groups and team workspaces
- Tagging and social bookmarking
- Permissions and privacy

Evaluating and Selecting Collaboration Software Tools



How to find the correct collaboration software for your firm

- What are the collaboration challenges facing the firm in terms of time and space?
  - Locate your firm in the time/space matrix. Your firm can occupy more than one cell in the matrix.
  - Different collaboration tools will be needed for each situation.
- Within each cell of the matrix where your firm faces challenges, exactly what kinds of solutions are available?
  - Make a list of vendor products.
- Analyze each of the products in terms of their cost and benefits to your firm.
  - Be sure to include the costs of training in your cost estimates, and the costs of involving the information systems department if needed.

How to find the correct collaboration software for your firm

- Identify the risks to security and vulnerability involved with each of the products.
  - Is your firm willing to put proprietary information into the hands of external service providers over the Internet?
  - Is your firm willing to risk its important operations to systems controlled by other firms?
  - What are the financial risks facing your vendors?
  - Will they be here in three to five years?
  - What would be the cost of making a switch to another vendor in the event the vendor firm fails?
- Seek the help of potential users to identify implementation and training issues.
  - Some of these tools are easier to use than others.
- Make your selection of candidate tools, and invite the vendors to make presentations.

The Role of the Information Systems Function in a business

- The Information Systems Department
  - The formal organizational unit responsible for information technology services
    - Programmers, Systems analysts
    - Information systems manager
    - Chief Information officer (CIO)
    - Chief Security officer (CSO,CISO)
    - Chief Privacy officer (CPO)
    - Chief Knowledge officer (CKO)
    - Chief Data officer (CDO)
    - End Users

Organizing the Information Systems Function

- There are many types of business firms, and there are many ways in which the IT function is organized within the firm.
  - A very small company will not have a formal information systems group.
  - Larger companies will have a separate information systems department
- The question of how the information systems department should be organized is part of the larger issue of **IT governance.**

Review Questions

1. What are business processes? How are they related to information systems?
2. How do systems serve the different management groups in a business?
3. How do systems that link the enterprise improve organizational performance?
4. Why are systems for collaboration and social business so important and what technologies do they use?

Summary

- Why are systems for collaboration and social business so important and what technologies do they use?
  - Collaboration
  - Social Business
- What is the role of the information systems function in a business?
  - The information systems department and it's functionalty

References

- Management Information Systems
- 14th Edition
- by Laudon, K. C ., & Laudon, J. P

Questions ???



Thank You